

LEDGER

Personal Budget & Finance Tracker

User Guide & Tester Checklist

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Overview & Getting Started

What is Ledger?

Ledger is a personal budget app that helps you track income, expenses, and recurring bills all in one place. You import your bank statements, review the transactions, and the app organizes everything by month. Over time it builds a complete financial history you can search, filter, and analyze.

Signing In

1. Open the app link in any web browser on your phone or computer. No download needed.
2. Click Sign in with Google and choose any Google account.
3. Your data is private. Other users cannot see your information.
4. After signing in you land on the Dashboard.

Note: Every change saves automatically to the cloud. There is no Save button anywhere in the app.

Getting Around

Use the navigation bar at the bottom of the screen on mobile, or the left sidebar on desktop, to move between the six sections of the app.

Dashboard —

Your monthly summary — income, spending, and bills at a glance

Import —

Upload bank statements to bring in new transactions

Ledger —

Browse and edit all your saved transactions

Bills —

Manage recurring bills and plan by paycheck

Analytics —

Charts and spending breakdowns over time

Rules —

Set up automatic category rules for future imports

Note: The month selector at the top of every page controls which month you are viewing. Always confirm you are on the right month before reviewing your data.

Section 01 — Dashboard

What You See Here

The Dashboard is the first screen after signing in. It gives you a quick snapshot of the selected month: money in, money out, your balance, and the status of your bills.

The Five Summary Cards

Total Income —

All money coming in this month — paychecks, deposits, etc.

Total Spending —

All money going out this month — every expense you imported

Balance —

Income minus spending — your net result for the month

Bills Due —

How many recurring bills have not been marked paid yet

Bills Paid —

The total dollar amount of bills you have already checked off

Spending by Category

Below the cards is a breakdown of your spending split by category — Bills, Fuel, Medical, Shopping, and so on. This updates instantly whenever you import or edit transactions.

Recent Transactions

The bottom of the dashboard shows your most recent transactions for the selected month. These are for reference only. To edit any of them, go to the Ledger section.

Note: Switch months using the selector at the top to review any past month. All cards and charts recalculate automatically.

Section 02 — Import

What Import Does

Import is how you bring bank transactions into the app. You upload a file from your bank, the app reads it, and shows you a preview. You review each transaction, adjust categories if needed, then confirm. Nothing is saved until you click Confirm Import.

Method 1 — CSV File

1. Go to Import and make sure CSV is selected at the top.
2. Click Select CSV File and choose the file you downloaded from your bank website.
3. A table appears listing every transaction found in the file.
4. Review each row. The app will have already guessed the category for most of them.
5. Each row has an Action dropdown: Save to keep it, Skip to ignore it, or Review to flag it.
6. When the list looks right, click Confirm Import. Saved transactions appear in your Ledger.

Note: To get a CSV from your bank, log into your bank website, go to your transaction history, and look for an Export or Download option. Choose CSV format.

Method 2 — AI Vision (PDF or Screenshot)

1. Go to Import and select AI Vision at the top.
2. Click Upload Statement and choose a PDF or image of your bank statement.
3. The AI reads the document and pulls out all income and expense transactions. This takes about 10 to 20 seconds.
4. You see the same preview table. Review, adjust categories, then click Confirm Import.

Note: AI Vision works with PDF files, JPG photos, PNG screenshots, and HEIC images. If your bank does not offer CSV export, screenshot your statement and use this method.

Marking a Transaction as a Recurring Bill During Import

While reviewing your import list, every expense row shows a small Add Recurring button below its category dropdown.

1. Find a transaction that is a bill you pay every month, like a car note or subscription.
2. Click the Add Recurring button on that row. It lights up green.
3. When you click Confirm Import, those transactions automatically create entries in your Bills list with the correct name, amount, and due day. No manual entry needed.

Note: A counter appears in the summary bar showing how many you have marked. The success message tells you how many recurring bills were added to your Bills list.

Section 03 — Ledger

What the Ledger Is

The Ledger is your full transaction history. Every income and expense you have ever imported or added manually lives here, organized by month. You can search, filter, edit, and delete anything from this page.

Reading the List

Each row shows the date, transaction name, a category badge, and the amount. Income entries show a green plus sign. Transactions flagged for review appear in orange.

Searching and Filtering

1. Use the search bar at the top to find any transaction by name as you type.
2. Use the category filter to show only one category at a time.
3. Switch months with the month selector at the top to view any past month.

Editing a Transaction

1. Click the pencil icon on the row you want to edit.
2. A form appears. Change the name, amount, date, category, or status.
3. Click Save. The Dashboard totals and Analytics charts update immediately.

Deleting a Transaction

1. Click the trash icon on the row.
2. Confirm the deletion. The transaction is permanently removed.

Note: Deleting a transaction from the Ledger does NOT affect your Bills list. Bills and transactions are separate — bills are a recurring template, transactions are your actual imported history.

Adding a Transaction Manually

Click the plus button at the top of the Ledger page. Fill in the date, name, amount, and category, then save. Use this for any charge that did not show up in your import.

Income Transactions

Paychecks and deposits get their own income category label — Paycheck, Freelance, Transfer, or Other Income. These count toward Total Income on the Dashboard separately from your expenses.

Section 04 — Bill Manager

What Bill Manager Is

Bill Manager holds your list of recurring charges — rent, car notes, subscriptions, utilities, medical payments, anything that repeats every month. Set them up once and they appear every month automatically. You never re-enter them.

Note: Bill Manager is your bill template, not your transaction history. Think of it as a list pinned to your fridge that you check off each month as you pay.

Three Ways to Add Bills

Option A — Paste List (Fastest)

1. Click the Paste List button in the Bill Manager header.
2. A text box appears. Paste your bills in this format:

```
Vehicle:
03/11 -- Wells Fargo Auto Loan: $181.39
03/23 -- Oklahoma Motor Credit: $290.00

Subscriptions:
Monthly -- Netflix: $7.00
Monthly -- ChatGPT: $21.19
```

3. Click Parse Bills. A preview table appears showing all the bills found.
4. Every row in the preview is editable. Click any name, amount, or day number to change it. Click the X on a row to remove a bill you do not want.
5. Click Import All Bills to save everything in the table.

Option B — Mark During Import

While reviewing a bank statement import, click Add Recurring on any expense row. On confirm that transaction automatically becomes a bill entry. See the Import section for full details.

Option C — Add Manually

Click the plus button at the top of Bill Manager. Fill in the name, amount, due day (1 through 31), and category. Save it.

Editing or Deleting a Bill

1. Pencil icon — opens an edit form. Change the name, amount, due day, or category and save. The update applies to every future month immediately.
2. Trash icon — permanently removes the bill from your list and all future months.

Note: If a bill amount changes, like your phone plan increases, edit that one bill and the new

amount shows up for the current month and all future months.

Bill	Amount	Frequency	Start Date	End Date
Electric	100	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Water	50	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Gas	75	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Internet	30	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Phone	20	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Insurance	150	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Property Tax	200	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Car Payment	100	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Student Loan	100	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Health Insurance	100	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Life Insurance	50	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Retirement	100	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Charity	20	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Subscription	10	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020
Other	0	Monthly	1/1/2020	12/31/2020

Note: If a bill amount changes, like your phone plan increases, edit that one bill and the new

amount shows up for the current month and all future months.

Marking Bills as Paid

Each bill row has a circle button on the right. Tap it when you pay the bill. A green checkmark appears and the row dims. Tap again to un-mark. Paid status is tracked separately per month.

Paycheck Planner

1. Click the Paycheck button and enter your two pay days, for example day 6 and day 20.
2. Two side-by-side panels appear: Paycheck 1 and Paycheck 2.
3. Each panel shows the bills in that window, the total amount, and how much is already paid.

Bills sort automatically into the correct window based on their due day. Each bill shows its day number clearly labeled.

Detect — Auto-Find Recurring Bills

1. Click Detect (the scan icon in the header). The app scans all your imported transaction history.
2. A list of suggested recurring bills appears. Bills already in your list show a blue Already Tracked badge.
3. Check the bills you want to add, uncheck any you do not want, then click Add Selected.

Note: Detect works best after you have imported at least two months of bank statements. More history means more accurate pattern detection.

Section 05 — Analytics

What Analytics Shows

Analytics gives you visual charts and breakdowns of your spending. Nothing here can be edited — it is a read-only view that helps you spot trends and understand where your money goes.

Spending by Category

A chart shows the percentage and dollar amount that went to each category this month. You can see at a glance which category is your biggest expense.

Month-over-Month Comparison

A bar chart compares your total income and spending across recent months so you can see whether your spending is trending up or down over time.

Note: If a chart looks empty it means no transactions have been imported for that month yet. Import a statement and the charts fill in automatically.

Section 06 — Rules Engine

What the Rules Engine Is

The Rules Engine lets you create automatic category assignments so that future imports require less manual work. Example: any transaction with Planet Fitness in the name should always be categorized as Bills. Once active, every future import applies the rule automatically.

Creating a Rule

1. Go to Rules and click Add Rule.
2. Set the condition — choose a field like Name, an operator like contains, and the value to match.
3. Set the action — usually Set Category, then choose the category.
4. Set a priority number. Lower numbers run first when multiple rules could match the same transaction.
5. Click Save Rule.

Testing a Rule with Run Test

Before saving a rule you can test it against your existing transaction history to confirm it works correctly.

1. Build your rule condition and action as normal.
2. Click Run Test without saving yet.
3. The app shows every past transaction this rule would have matched and what category it would have set.
4. If the results look right, click Save. If not, adjust the condition and run the test again.

Note: Rules only apply to new imports going forward. They do not retroactively change transactions already saved. To fix past transactions, edit them individually in the Ledger.

Section 07 — Tester Checklist

How to Use This Checklist

Work through each item. Check the box when it works as described. If something does not work, write a note about what you expected versus what happened and send it back. You do not need to finish in one session.

Account & Sign In

- ☐ App opens at the URL without any error message
 - ☐ Sign in with Google works and you reach the Dashboard
 - ☐ Signing out and signing back in restores your data
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Dashboard

- ☐ All five summary cards are visible: Income, Spending, Balance, Bills Due, Bills Paid
 - ☐ Switching months with the month selector updates all card values
 - ☐ Spending by category section appears below the cards
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Import — CSV

- ☐ Selecting CSV and clicking Select CSV File opens a file picker
 - ☐ Uploading a bank CSV shows a preview table of transactions
 - ☐ Category dropdowns on each row let you change the category
 - ☐ Action dropdowns let you set Save, Skip, or Review on each row
 - ☐ Re-importing the same file highlights duplicates in yellow
 - ☐ Confirm Import saves the transactions and you land on the Ledger
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Import — AI Vision

- ☐ Selecting AI Vision and clicking Upload Statement opens a file picker
 - ☐ Uploading a PDF or image shows a loading spinner while the AI reads it
 - ☐ After analysis a preview table of extracted transactions appears
 - ☐ Both income and expense transactions appear in the table
 - ☐ Add Recurring button appears on expense rows below the category dropdown
 - ☐ Clicking Add Recurring highlights it in green
 - ☐ Success message after confirm shows how many recurring bills were added
 - ☐ Newly marked bills appear in Bill Manager after import
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Ledger

- ☐ Imported transactions show in the Ledger under the correct month
- ☐ Search bar filters the list by name as you type
- ☐

Category filter narrows the list correctly

- ☐ Pencil icon opens an edit form for a transaction
 - ☐ Editing a transaction and saving updates it everywhere immediately
 - ☐ Trash icon deletes a transaction after confirmation
 - ☐ Adding a transaction manually with the plus button works
 - ☐ Income transactions show with a green label
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Bill Manager

- ☐ Paste List button opens a text box dialog
 - ☐ Pasting a bill list and clicking Parse Bills shows a preview table
 - ☐ Name, amount, and day fields in the preview table are editable
 - ☐ X button removes a row from the preview before importing
 - ☐ Import All Bills saves the remaining rows and they appear in the bill list
 - ☐ Each bill row shows a day number with the word day labeled beneath it
 - ☐ Pencil icon opens an edit form and saves changes correctly
 - ☐ Trash icon removes a bill permanently
 - ☐ Circle button marks a bill paid with a green checkmark and dims the row
 - ☐ Marking paid in one month does not affect other months
 - ☐ Paycheck button opens a form to enter two pay days
 - ☐ After setting pay days two side-by-side paycheck panels appear
 - ☐ Bills in the paycheck panels show day number, name, and amount
 - ☐ Detect button scans history and suggests recurring bills
 - ☐ Bills already in your list show a blue Already Tracked badge in Detect results
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Analytics

- ☐ Analytics page loads without errors
 - ☐ Spending chart shows category breakdown for months with imported data
 - ☐ Month-over-month chart appears when multiple months have data
 - ☐ Switching months updates the charts
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Rules Engine

- ☐ Rules page loads and shows existing rules or an empty state message
 - ☐ Add Rule form accepts a condition and action
 - ☐ Run Test shows matching transactions from your history
 - ☐ Saving a rule adds it to the list
 - ☐ Toggling a rule off disables it without deleting it
 - ☐ Deleting a rule removes it from the list
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General

- ☐ App works on a mobile phone browser
 - ☐ No unexpected error messages appear during normal use
 - ☐ Navigation between all six sections works without errors
 - ☐ Month selector works on every page
- Thank you for testing. Report any issues with: feature name, what you expected, and what actually happened.

